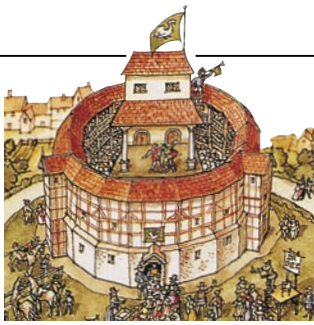
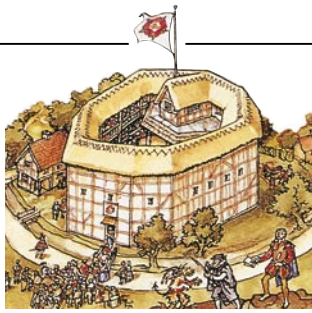




The Swan, built by Philip Henslowe, dyer



The Rose, built by Francis Langley, goldsmith and draper

IN IT FOR THE MONEY

Most of the early playhouses, including the Swan and the Rose, were built by businessmen. They saw them as a way to make money. London's first playhouses were the Theatre, built in 1576, and the Curtain, built in 1577. Their round design was copied from earlier buildings like the Bear Garden.

Site of the Theatre



Site of the Curtain

A lucky gambler's winnings

CONEYCATCHERS

Gambling was a risky pastime because London was full of criminals who made a living by cheating at cards and dice. These cheats were called coneycatchers, and they were always on the lookout for newcomers from the countryside like William Shakespeare. They called their victims coneys (rabbits).

The bears had their own names, such as Harry Hunks and Sackerson



Brown bear

Bear Garden

Site of the Rose (built in 1587)

Bear baiting in the 16th century



TETHERED AND TOOTHLESS

In the Bear Garden, dogs were set against a bear tied to a stake. The bear's teeth were sometimes pulled out to give the dogs a better chance. Shakespeare's Scottish king Macbeth compares himself to a baited bear: "They have tied me to the stake; I cannot fly, but bearlike I must stay and fight the course."